MACHINE TRANSCRIPT · CORAGGIO CONSULTING

Virginia Board of Education, Special Committee on Standards of Accreditation, Wednesday, March 17, 2021

Date	Wednesday, March 17, 2021
Place	Virginia Board of Education (Virginia Department of Education), Richmond, Virginia
Length	2h 21m (video)

- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=lfw6lprxWLM
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

> Machine transcript (speech-to-text) produced by Coraggio Consulting. Not an official county record. Names and numbers may be misspelled; check the video at the timestamp before quoting.

Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-24. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:00:17] good afternoon everyone good afternoon hello just so that those folks that are watching us on the

[00:00:53] live stream know what meeting is getting ready to occur i'm just gonna pull up this title slide and

[00:00:58] once we have everybody dr pexton i'll turn it over to you to to get us going sounds good we're just

[00:02:07] waiting on a few more folks to join us dr pexton emily my computer is doing really strange things

[00:02:50] so if they persist i may have to jump out and jump back in so i'm gonna try to navigate it without doing so but if you see me leave that's the reason why okay no problem thanks for letting us know and it looks like we're just waiting on uh mrs davis vought and dr duran to join us i don't see either one of them hopped on yet so we'll give them a couple of minutes to before we

[00:03:29] get started we do have mrs davis fox so we're just waiting on dr duran to join us up dr duran is there

[00:04:38] all righty i will stop my screen share so that we can actually see everybody and dr pexton i'll turn it over to you great thank you good afternoon everybody uh happy saint patrick's day uh to everyone. I want to thank you for joining us for a meeting of the special committee to review the standards of accreditation. Before we dive into our meeting and agenda, as always, I want to thank both the committee members and the staff and the public for their continued engagement in this work.

[00:05:15] I would like to formally welcome two of our newest board members to their first special committee meeting uh and so that's dr roberson and mr swan welcome uh looking forward to your insight and participation in today's discussion um i will digress for a second and talk a little bit about daylight savings time i know it's uh wearing on me this week and i i learned a little nugget on the news i think it was monday they said you know to help overcome that one hour of sleep that we lost they recommend going to bed every night 15 minutes earlier i have failed at doing that three

[00:05:53] nights in a row um i don't even think i have a bedtime and that's probably part of the problem but if any of you feel like i feel right now daylight savings time is starting to uh catch up with me but i digress um so we'll jump into today's uh discussion and agenda uh during today's committee meeting we will continue moving forward with our committee work plan based of our based off of our November 2020 discussion. So first up we will receive a presentation from BDOE staff

[00:06:26] on technical changes and corrections to the 2017 SOA revisions and then following that presentation we will hear from members from the African-American Superintendent's Advisory Council as this council has prepared some recommendations for us to consider related to advancing racial equality equity excuse me uh to complement the aasac presentation and that's an acronym i'm gonna have to get good at in this conversation in this discussion uh dr leslie sale and miss leah walker will discuss how the committee can integrate those these recommendations into the current soa

[00:07:05] so before we move to our presentations has the have the committee members had a chance to review the minutes from the january 27th 2021 committee meeting from virtual nods okay um are there are there uh can i get a motion to approve or amend the minutes so move to approve the minutes thank you dr duran can i get a second second thank you dr wilson and we'll do a roll call vote uh starting

[00:07:40] with Dr. Duran. Aye. Dr. Wilson. Aye. Ms. Davis-Thought. Aye. And the chair votes aye as well. Great. Thank you. So moving up to our first agenda item today, the review of proposed technical edits to the SOA. The department has had an internal staff work group related to the SOA that meets on a regular basis to discuss implementation and needed edits. So today's

[00:08:14] presentation includes recommendations of technical edits from the staff work group. Our presenters today are Dr. Leslie Sale, VDOE Director of Policy, and Julie Malik, VDOE Director of Accountability. So ladies, I will turn it over to you. Thank you, Dr. Peckson. Can everyone hear me okay? Wonderful. And I will go ahead and get the PowerPoint presentation queued up. So it is a year

[00:08:49] later and i am now just navigating trying to work on two screens um so you may notice me looking over to the corner um but that is just me trying to be as tech savvy as possible um and certainly not an expression of of interest or engagement in our conversations here today so just wanted to to offer a little preface um if you see me looking over uh for the new board members that are joining us this afternoon just wanted to quickly introduce myself i am leslie sale i am director of the office of policy with the department of education and as dr pexton mentioned i'm also joined today

[00:09:27] by mr julie malik who is the director of our office of accountability who has been a colleague and a companion of mine on our soa implementation work group which is as dr pexton also mentioned composed of a cross-section of agency staff and we had originally come together and convened to help support the implementation of the revised standards of accreditation when it went into effect in the 2018-2019 school year and from that work the group has spent a good amount of time compiling and vetting a number of technical edits to our soa which we are bringing

[00:10:02] here before you today i will share that these edits are are those that we consider to be technical in nature so we are not changing the intent or application of soa provisions so we do still anticipate as a group that we'll see more substantive edits to come from both our internal implementation work group side as well as the soa special committee side but we still felt like these edits are an important step in making the standards of accreditation a functional and accessible document for schools and divisions and those folks who who use the soa the most so wanted to make sure we are clear and concise in what we're offering in the standards of

[00:10:41] accreditation so many of the items addressed in today's presentation have been flagged in our earlier discussions with the committee and at the time when we brought these to you earlier our suggestions were still kind of in a conceptual space and we hadn't translated those yet to language so now with language in hand we wanted to provide you with an opportunity to review and react to how those changes look on paper we hope that you all have had an opportunity to read through the edits and you'll find that most are pretty self-explanatory and with that in mind Ms. Malik and I will only touch on a few of the highlighted edits in each section that we felt

[00:11:20] were of note but as you see and we move through the presentation each of our slides lists a short explanation for everything that we've done in each section to help jog your memory so if there's anything that you would like additional clarification on or us to expand on we can certainly you know take questions or or answer anything to to expound upon what we have a little bit further so after that substantive prelude there um we have organized our presentation into the parts that we've discussed and and how we've structured our presentations to you before um and to ease us

[00:11:57] into the discussion i will start us with parts one and two here um because there's actually a very little to report at this time um i will say that i i am highlighting this because we do expect changes to come in part one um this is actually where our definition section is housed in the standards of accreditation um so while it would seem a little preempted to go ahead and start changing our updated terms and concepts to reflect what we're doing in the body of the document we know that there will probably be a package of changes to come and be forthcoming to this group

[00:12:29] here um so part one um changes will will still be in route to you um here shortly just a quick review of the next part that you'll see in terms of um you know sub not substantive changes technical changes um part three which we know has a number of our meteor sections related to graduation requirements assessments grade promotion remediation and transfer students i think understandably so required a number of technical edits to make sure everything that we wanted to communicate was being done so clearly and effectively and just a short recap there of

[00:13:07] what those part three is incorporates in terms of sections again we will have some more substantive edits coming for you um in in our future presentations and discussions but on today's presentation really focuses on those technical edits in section 30 which is related to student achievement

um our red bullet point is our edit of note here and that is a clarification to one of our subsections as it relates to our end of course standards of learning assessments that students are required to take and a little bit of context and for those folks who have the document

[00:13:45] open this is actually edit number two if you're looking at your table of contents and flipping down to the edit and the language itself but to again give a little bit of context prior to the 2017 soa revision which again went into effect in the 2018-2019 school year students who were enrolled in a class that had an end of course sol test were required to take it but under the the revised SOA, students take SOL tests only if they are needed for verified credit or required to meet federal accountability. However, existing wording has resulted in

[00:14:20] some unintended consequences that require students to take an end-of-course test if they are enrolled in the class with an end-of-course test but have not yet earned the verified credit. And the reason that becomes a little bit complicated and clunky for our students Is that there are some students who are enrolled in courses and discipline areas that they have an end of course test associated with them, but they also will be taking a test for federal accountability and future course work.

[00:14:48] So a couple example to think about kind of the situation we're looking to remedy here is a student who is enrolled in earth science course before biology. is asked to take the earth science test even though they will later be asked to take the biology end of course test to meet federal accountability so it recognizes kind of the chronology and order of operations in terms of how some sol end of course tests and tests required for federal accountability stack up in a student's schedule so really this this revision just helps align us

[00:15:21] with our intent to our language here i will jump to our graduation section beginning with subsection 50 and this is effective for our students that entered ninth grade prior to the implementation of the new soa so those were years 2018 2019 again we have our list of all of the technical edits that came with this section but the two in red are the highlighted ones that we think might be useful just to chat with you about and these are just clarifications to make sure it is clear what types of courses can be used to fulfill certain graduation requirements

[00:16:01] so the first is helping us make sure that the computer science course credit substitutions kind of a mouthful of a phrase there are only applicable when you use board approved computer science courses so it's making sure that that folks that use the soa document as as really kind of a lay of the land for student coursework and helping them map their progress to graduation understand that there's that additional board document that approves courses that can be used for graduation so additionally we added some language around the virtual course requirements

[00:16:37] and because of the degree of exposure that we know students are already receiving in the virtual coursework space and recognizing that students may want to balance their virtual experiences with some in-person experience that we felt that the virtual course requirement could be fulfilled by a course that was fully virtual or done in a blended modality so the students still have that exposure to the virtual coursework but we know that coursework can look a number of different ways and utilize a number of different modalities if you are flipping through your document those two edits that i just made reference to are edits number four and five so you can see how those

[00:17:16] translate to the specific language in our subsection 50. before i jump to the next page i will quickly note that you'll notice a number of these have asterisks attached to them because a lot of the

language in 50 and 51 mirror one another we didn't carry all over all of those edits um so for ease of read but these are edits for clarification that are both in 50 and 51 so you'll see the similar language changes in both graduation sections so as noted in addition to

[00:17:54] those asterisk items that were included from 50 um including the the clarifying edits around graduation requirements one notable change that we wanted to make sure was flagged for you in 51 is one related to one of our career and technical education diploma seals and this was just to make sure that the rigor that we intend to come with our diploma seals is reflected in the language so for our career and technical education students who are seeking that diploma seal we wanted to make sure that the student is maintaining a certain grade level in their coursework specifically a b in their cte coursework and pass an exam leading to certification or

[00:18:33] credentials so right now it's an or and we want to make sure that those students are completing both of those requirements prior to be earning a seal and again this is just making sure that our language is clear and that our requirements align with the level of rigor that we expect for students that earn and are seeking and earn our diploma seals for those folks who are again in our document and looking at our table of contents if you flip to the edit number 20 or flip to the edit numbered 27 you'll see the language changes there as well as a few just

[00:19:05] clarifying edits around what concentration and specialization means for our CTE courses and then lastly at least for the the items that I will be reviewing with you today in our transfer students section which is in subsection 60. one of the highlights that we wanted to make sure you are aware of today is that we clarified discipline area verified credit requirements for our late transfer students and so because our 11th grade students may not have as many opportunities to

[00:19:40] earn verified credits and may not need certain courses to get to graduation we wanted to make sure that those students have the flexibility that they needed to to align with both federal accountability but to get the verified credits they needed for graduation so this edit provides the flexibility to those late transfer students and the type of transfer credits they need to earn.

[00:20:03] So for those 11th graders coming in as transfers they would need one verified credit in English and one in a subject area of the student's own choosing and the big change there is that that was formally a credit required in the mathematics area. And that is edit number 31 if you flip into your document and want to take a peek at the language that we have there. So with that I am going to hand it over to my colleague julie malik to walk us through the remainder of the edits

[00:20:35] all right thank you dr sale um i appreciate that great inter introduction i'm going to continue this conversation with part four which focuses on the instructional program there are quite a few subsections here to include elementary middle and secondary schools summer school cte standard school year and day as well as library media and extracurricular activities so there's quite a bit packed into part four so again we're just going to expect that you had a chance to

[00:21:12] review some of these in your document and we are just going to touch on a couple items that we wanted to expand on just a touch section 70 speaks to instruction generally and that is just a quick review of some of those items we didn't have any that we wanted to spend any particular amount of time on today unless you choose to bring something up we'll we'd be happy to speak of it next slide okay in sections 80 and 90 they focus on elementary programs and middle school programs

[00:21:48] the technical aid we wanted to bring forth to you today is the reordered section not only did we propose a technical edit in 80 and 90 to reorder some of the some of the parts that were more general we had may have had a a subsection a or b or c um where there was more more general statements across all schools and all disciplines within the school and then it broke up into more specificity like k3 schools or different different disciplines so we we've just reordered for clarity so that the general items are at the top and then it reduces in

[00:22:28] specificity i do want to say that this is this is a project that we are working on we hope to reorder some other items to increase clarity and to make it flow a little bit better so you may see some more of these edits as we move forward such as moving perhaps some some language about remediation programs to the instructional section rather than in part three where it currently lives we feel that that might be more appropriate. Also, if we go to the next slide, another item that we might

[00:23:05] consider reordering is this section 110. 110 speaks of the requirements around the verified credits and what that means and what they look like. And we're considering moving this not for your review today. We'll bring it at another time, perhaps before the graduation requirements again just for flow um so verified credit seems to impact their graduation requirements more so than a lot of other areas so that's another reordering that we're considering that we'll bring to you at another at a later date again these are just some some topics that might

[00:23:42] spur your memory from when you read that document before the meeting today next slide part five speaks to school instructional leadership roles role of principal teaching staff support staff there is one technical edit we'd like to just touch on today and that's in the role of principal again we don't want to spend a whole lot of time on this but just to trigger your memory but this is really to modernize the language and update the language of all the new fancy tools that the students may have within the standardized testing environment to try and catch off

[00:24:20] so that the the principal is responsible for being aware of some of those tools and making them unavailable during standardized tests next slide so on to parts um six and seven part six and seven we don't have any technical edits for you today but we do anticipate through continued conversations with some of our guests today and um some of the other offices that we will bring forth some more substantive changes for these two parts in the future part eight is accreditation

[00:24:56] and that walks the reader through the measures that we use for accreditation, the accreditation ratings, the indicators, and all of those wonderful accreditation topics we've discussed in the past. It also is really important to circle back around to the school improvement efforts and the supports and the technical support that VDOE provides schools at the conclusion of the accreditation cycle. So the technical edit that we would like to bring forth is about that cycle. Next slide,

[00:25:31] please. There are a couple of technical edits that we brought to you, but the one that we wanted to focus on today was language around the school improvement process. The Office of School Quality does a great job working with divisions who have been indicated through the accreditation program as a possible need of support and monitoring. And through their work, they've discovered that there's a slight language disconnect between what is in the SOA and what is typically the vernacular within the divisions. So the technical edit here is to streamline this

[00:26:09] conversation and really make sure everyone knows that we're talking about the multi-year school improvement plan when we talk about the monitoring processes in the vehicle for the office of

school quality it also brings forth the fact that all schools should have a multi-year school improvement plan so just um streamlining that language that everyone understands that there aren't a multitude of different plans um sometimes just your current multi-year school improvement plan is the vehicle which some of these some of these assistants and the of school quality will work with the school

[00:26:46] through that plan rather than it being something totally different. So there was interest in making that simpler so that everyone understood what plan we were talking about. So next slide. I think that's the last edit we were going to speak of today, Leslie.

[00:27:05] All right, and we are happy to take any questions that you have about the specific edits or if you'd like us to revisit some of the ones that we didn't touch on, either julie or i would be happy to speak to this further great thank you very much for that presentation so to uh to their point we'll open it up to the committee or any other board members

[00:27:32] or attendees that might have any questions uh or thoughts um no questions but i just want to thank you for that and for the work i see a lot of the detail that went into this and i think it will be very helpful for clarification for schools and for parents as well as teachers and students that are trying to understand particularly that the the and versus the or and i think those areas where you indicated the change really is an alignment what we were expecting wanting students to do so i appreciate the clarification and i'm sure the a lot of work and thought that went into it so no

[00:28:12] questions just thank you great thing the scanning making sure i'm not seeing any other hands up of course if you do if you do have a comment just come off mute okay great well echo dr duran's sentiment thank you again uh for the presentation um we will move on to the next part of our agenda uh and that's going to be uh uh hearing from uh the african-american superintendent's advisory

[00:28:48] council which we are delighted and looking very much forward uh to doing uh the purpose of the aasac is to advise inform and provide professional insight on policy development and accountability for public education in Virginia and the council was formed to provide advice and recommendations to Dr. Lane and the VDOE leadership team and may be called upon to inform the board on policy matters. Given the special committee's focus on equity and accountability, the work and recommendations of the AASAC is complementary to our work. The AASAC members joining us today

[00:29:26] are Mr. Rashard Wright, who is the Chief of Staff in Newport News Public Schools, right down the street from Manhattan. Mr. Miles Hunt, a student school board representative in Portsmouth City Schools, Portsmouth City Public Schools, not too much farther down the street. Dr. Tamisha Grimes, I hope I pronounced that right, Dr. Grimes, Superintendent of Nottaway County Public Schools, and the honorable jim dyke former virginia secretary of education to governor doug wilder so mr wright i will turn it over to you to kick off this presentation thank you dr pexton and

[00:30:05] board members thank you so much for this time and honest honestly i'm very honored to serve as the chair to this great council but before i uh kick our recommendations off and you meet some of our other council members i just really wanted to thank dr james lane i wanted to thank you sir for your courage and your willingness to ensure that we took on this very important work wanted to let you know that your leadership matters as we create equitable environments for our students here in the state of virginia so thank you again dr lane so you you can see our

[00:30:42] agenda here on the screen and again i mentioned that i will not be alone we have a wonderful student representative and also a virginia superintendent and a former secretary of Education that will be a part of this presentation, so you will hear from them shortly. Thank you, Dr. Paxton, also for mentioning the purpose of the African American Superintendents Advisory Council, but also our council was formed in response to acute equity issues that continue to stifle and produce desperate academic outcomes for Black students across the state of Virginia.

[00:31:19] We really have focused on making sure that we align ourselves to the road map to equity, navigating EdEquity VA and we outline prevalent gaps in achievement that impact our Black students. So our charge. The charge of the African American Superintendents Advisory Council is to advise the state superintendent, VDOE leadership, and the Virginia Board of Education on matters pertaining to racial equity in Virginia schools. Additionally, we've been charged with providing VDOE leadership with recommendations intended to improve the holistic educational experience for Black students

[00:31:57] which are made vulnerable by the conditions of systemic racism in our education system. Our advisory council members were appointed by Dr. Lane in the fall of 2020 for a one-year term and could eventually serve subsequent years.

[00:32:17] We have provided you a list of the members, and again that's been sent to you, but you can see that on the screen here. Very excited about our membership and the work that we've been doing. so our council members board we've identified four main domain areas in the education system that must be addressed right away to advance racial equity and those are achievement gaps teacher diversity opportunity gaps and professional development in the areas of equity and culturally responsive inclusive practices at this time i'd like to turn the

[00:32:52] presentation over to our student representative mr miles hunt and also dr tamisha grimes superintendent in ottaway county schools to review our recommendations and later you will also hear from our secretary uh former secretary miles thank you so much mr writing good afternoon everyone the racial achievement gap manifests as disparities in test scores graduation rates and other success metrics reflects system the system system systemic excuse me impact on ongoing

[00:33:27] historical trauma in the systemic oppression of people of color in order to address virginia's racial achievement gaps we must assess the conditions of our educational system which continue to perpetuate disparate academic achievement among minoritized students exclusionary discipline practices or any type of disciplinary action that removes or excludes a student from their usual educational setting continues to disproportionately affect Black students in Virginia schools.

[00:34:03] While Black students comprise only 22% of total student enrollment, they make up 52% of all students suspended. Black students are more than twice as likely as their non-Black peers to be suspended.

[00:34:20] In 30% of Virginia school divisions, Black female students are more than three times as likely as their non-Black peers to be suspended. As the Virginia Department of Education shifts away from a focus on achievement gaps which places the blame for lower achievement on students of color and their families, an increased focus is being placed on the conditions of the educational system that perpetuate inequities.

[00:34:51] Closing opportunity gaps in Virginia schools is the only way we will make progress toward eliminating the academic achievement gaps. Opportunity gaps describe the complex issues that contribute to achievement gaps and recognizes the historical and societal implications of the way race and class influence the kind of education and access to support a student is likely to receive. Opportunity gaps often manifest as a lack of equitable and consistent

[00:35:28] access to rigorous courses and learning opportunities a lack of access to high levels of support that measurably increased achievement levels for all students and lowered expectations for underrepresented and marginalized students under representation of black students in gifted education falls under the larger umbrella of opportunity gaps that result in achievement gaps underrepresentation of black students in gifted education falls under the larger umbrella of opportunity gaps again that result in achievement gaps while white students make up 48 of total

[00:36:07] school enrollment 58 were identified as gifted and 53 were referred for services compared to black students comprising of 22 of coded student student enrollment only accounting for 12 of students identified as gifted, and 13% being referred to services. Additionally, the failure to assign students of color to advanced coursework has created a 26% gap in enrollment for advanced

[00:36:41] placement or dual enrollment courses between black and white students. Not only are black students less likely to be identified as gifted, but they are also more likely to be identified as requiring special education services by teachers. Dr. Grimes. Thank you so much and good afternoon everyone. Because academic and opportunity gaps are linked in cause and effect, we have grouped these recommendations together. Revised instructional and graduation requirements

[00:37:18] to ensure that course progressions provide equal emphasis on career and workforce readiness, include discipline disproportionality as an indicator in the state's accountability system, and require reporting of demographic data on enrollment in gifted programs, especially academic career centers on Virginia school quality profiles.

[00:37:44] Also for academic achievement and opportunity gaps, we recommend that we create an opportunity and access indicator, require schools and divisions to report on student enrollment and advanced courses, as well as report on the details of course offerings by school, and include a measure of access to academic rigor and accreditation, which could be a composite indicator.

[00:38:11] Continuing for academic achievement and opportunity gaps, recommendations include require schools to offer open enrollment and advanced level academic work, require that divisions evaluate master schedules to ensure equitable student assignment in honors or advanced and AP courses, and require reporting on demographic enrollment in these courses, and establish model guidance on equitable enrollment procedures for governor schools, accelerated programs. The culturally responsive school seeks the highest levels of achievement

[00:38:51] for all students by acknowledging, responding to, and truly integrating student, family, and community identity into all aspects of learning to foster a safe and equitable environment that recognizes the histories, struggles, achievements, and contributions of the racially marginalized populations it serves as being fundamental to engage student learning.

[00:39:16] Culturally responsive schools address fundamental equity concerns by holding high expectations for all students and providing the highest levels of support to ensure that all students

succeed. Success in a culturally responsive school is defined by preparation for college and career readiness in an environment that is supportive, that is asset conscious, and that fosters positive cultural identity. The Virginia Department of Education has prioritized increasing the cultural competency of Virginia's educator workforce as a strategy for achieving education equity.

[00:39:55] Recommendations include establish a single indicator or composite score related to school climate which also includes indicators of anti-racism and culturally responsive and inclusive school climate. Require an equity advisory committee at the division level and incorporate racism, racial equity, social justice as part of standards of learning. Establish a single a single indicator or composite score related to school climate which also includes indicators of

[00:40:33] anti-racism and culturally responsive and inclusive school climate require an equity advisory committee at the division level incorporate racism racial equity social justice as part of standards of learning require each school board to adopt an equity plan that is staff that includes the establishment of equity goals. Establish model efficacy tools to evaluate culturally responsive and inclusive instructional practice. Establish model culturally responsive and inclusive audit

[00:41:10] for all approved instructional materials, curriculum, and textbooks. Require educator preparation programs to include programs of study and experiences that prepare teachers to be culturally responsive by revising regulations governing the review and approval of education programs in Virginia as noted in code section 20-543-10 to include guidance on diversity, equity, cultural responsiveness and competence, anti-racism, and diverse field placements.

[00:41:44] Have a requirement for a culturally responsive and inclusive practices coordinator at every division. Require equitable distribution of teachers to disrupt the disparity of the most experienced teachers being assigned to the lowest poverty schools. Reconfigure division boundaries and zoning to promote better integration and to advance equitable access for all students by amplifying best practices, issuing model guidance, and advocating for inclusive school division

[00:42:19] boundaries. Virginia's educator workforce continues to be racially homogenous with a teacher population that is overwhelmingly white and female. As the diversity of Virginia student population rapidly grows, there is a critical need to recruit and retain educators that reflect the growing diversity across the state and that are prepared to meet the unique needs of our diverse student populations.

[00:42:54] Research and Virginia Department of Education staff analysis indicate that a racially representative mix of teachers and administrators have a positive effect on educational outcomes for or historically marginalized students, the current disproportionate racial composition Virginia's teachers workforce must be addressed as it poses a direct threat to the success of Virginia's increasingly diverse students.

[00:43:23] For every 1% increase in the percent of black teachers in every school, the suspension rate for black students decreases by 0.03%. Black students who are exposed to one black teacher by third grade are 13% more likely to enroll in college.

[00:43:45] And those who have had two black teachers are 32% more likely to enroll in college. - So our recommendations for teacher diversity include, require reporting on student to teacher racial ratios in the form of a single indicator or composite score related to teacher student demographics.

[00:44:10] This should be reported on school quality profiles as a teacher diversity index. Establish model guidance for mentoring and coaching program for the retention of teachers of color. Modify licensure regulations to permit alternative pathways other than the praxis such as through micro-credentials to meet licensure requirements.

[00:44:33] At this time, we would like to turn the presentation over to Mr. Dyke for final remarks. - Thank you very much and let me just say, I really appreciate having the opportunity to serve with this council and thank you, Dr. Lane, for giving me that opportunity.

[00:44:50] And I would be remiss if I didn't commend the two speakers ahead of me for a great job, especially our student representative. Let's give him a real shout out. Great job, Miles, very proud of you. Go ahead, you can clap. I realize it's virtual, but you can still interrupt with applause and claps when you feel like it.

[00:45:09] For me, it's really a personal privilege to come back and appear before the State Board of Education. As many of you know, I served for five years on the State Board, and I still remember the secret handshake, and it's always great to come back to be in front of you.

[00:45:24] It's also good to see my colleague, former Secretary Holton, and we have a separate secret handshake for former secretaries, so it's good to see you, Anne. I just have a few brief remarks I wanna make here at the end, And to put it in context, let me repeat something that I heard a while ago that I thought kind of captures this whole discussion about equity.

[00:45:49] And that is that equality is everyone having shoes. Equity is everyone having shoes that fit. Today, there's no bigger issue facing the Commonwealth than addressing the profound inequity in our educational system.

[00:46:08] Virginia was founded over 400 years ago on the principle of inequity. Over 60 years ago, Virginia chose to participate in massive resistance and closed its schools rather than provide equity in education.

[00:46:25] This is an indecent amount of time for our children to wait to fully receive what they are entitled to. For me, while serving as the first black Virginia secretary of education, one of my fondest memories was being the commencement speaker to an integrated class at Prince Edward County High School, which was, as you all recall, the ground zero of massive resistance.

[00:46:53] That experience showed me that progress has been made, but much more progress is needed to fulfill the dream. The Board of Education is uniquely positioned to lead. You are charged with advocating for every student to be provided a quality education.

[00:47:12] I appreciate the fact that you have begun to step up on that mandate by calling for increased funding and full funding the standards of quality to provide that educational opportunity for each one of our students today we as a nation and as a commonwealth are at a crossroads in the fight for equity and social justice as the lead character in the movie lincoln said the day of reckoning is nigh upon us that means we need to take bold action overcome our history to correct these inequities simply stated the

[00:47:51] The board must act now and it must act boldly. This is not an issue to be addressed gradually or at some future date. Virginia's children have waited far too long to receive the equity that they deserve.

[00:48:07] We need you to make good trouble, like the action taken by our former governor, Linwood Holton in the early 1970s, when he put his children, including your colleague Anne, into public schools in Richmond to show that Virginia was moving beyond massive resistance. That's an example of the leadership this board needs to show to address this issue. Years from now, when your children and grandchildren ask what you did on the day of reckoning on equity and social justice, you can say the board stood tall and devised a clear plan

[00:48:47] with fair and just recommendations to eliminate inequity and to assure that the education shoe fits every Virginia student, regardless of race, gender, economic status, physical ability, or place of origin. We are looking to you to provide that leadership, and this council stands with you to make sure that it gets done and that we carry this message to the people of the Commonwealth. Thank you for the opportunity to make a few closing remarks, and I'd like to

[00:49:22] return to Florida our Chair, Rashard. Thank you, Secretary Dyke. We would like to thank you, board again for inviting us to share our recommendations as you can see we spent a great deal of time a very thoughtful council to come up with these recommendations i'd also like to take this opportunity to share one final comment the aas ac would also like to commend and thank the board for including a new standard on culturally responsive and equitable practices and the revisions to the uniform performance standards for teacher evaluation the latest

[00:49:58] revisions to the indicators provide the necessary foundation for the development of these critical competencies for all virginia educators the asac supports the inclusion of culturally responsive standards and we look forward to the board taking action tomorrow so again thank you for your time and at this time we can take any questions you may have great um i you know i'm i'm left a little bit speechless i i really enjoyed and appreciated the uh the presentation itself i

[00:50:37] i do want to personally thank mr hunt um and and dr grimes and mr wright uh um mr dyke uh because this this discussion is is so important as we all recognize but what i appreciate about it is the level of detail uh i think what i'm really what what resonated with me was that either through the recommendations or even through some of the stats you can tell the level of of of depth of the discussions and the work that went into this to really uncover um some facts and

[00:51:12] some realities um that are facing our our our our children of color and our teachers of color today so i just really am am grateful for the presentation i'm certainly going to open it up to the board for dialogue and discussion. Before we do, I just I do have one thought that I've been trying to organize in my mind as I've been listening to your presentation and reading through and reading through your slide deck. You know, particularly around academic achievement and opportunity gaps, some of the recommendations that suggest, you know, require schools offer open

[00:51:49] enrollment in advanced level academic coursework or require that divisions evaluate master schedules to ensure equitable student assignments and honors and advanced classes certainly that is a step in the right direction to just open the gate right and to allow for students to walk through that door just even have a chance right without any potential disparate uh requirements you know unintended likely uh still causing some some negative consequences so wholly agree with the types of recommendations but walking through the doors I'm sure we all recognize is just the first

[00:52:25] step I think there's also surely a gap in the support that our children of color and teachers of color need to then sustain and find success once they've walked through that door and I you know some of

the recommendations like where I see have requiring all divisions to have an equity council and requiring boards to have an equity or schools to have an equity plan, you would think in some of those types of recommendations, actions would come out of it that would provide that type

[00:53:00] of support, right? But I guess my long-winded point is really interested in hearing from this, from the committee, what your discussion looked like around once we finally remove some of those barriers to entry, what does support look like after the fact? And I'm not looking for the grand answer. I'm just curious if you guys had some discussions around that and recognizing that additional challenge. Absolutely, Dr. Paxton. I think with what we've seen around special

[00:53:36] education advisory councils, gifted advisory councils, our budget advisory councils, we all know in education, we have to inspect what we expect. And if we can put the constructs in place around making equity a priority when it comes to access and opportunity, we absolutely believe that it will yield results. Around your question with supports, once we are providing our students an opportunity to share with us their dreams, right, because we have to match resources

[00:54:09] to dreams, particularly when it comes to students of color, then we can talk about the types of supports that they need we can't make assumptions that it's just the family a lot of times uh you know what's the role of the counselor and uh have we been able to go beyond the assumption that you may be you know you may be a discipline problem so there are a number of dynamics that we discuss but really it's access and opportunity and to elevate the conversation as we've done with our va equity plan and our equity five c's and just the fact that we're here making these recommendations and then we can really talk about the very specific resources that need to be put in place

[00:54:49] to to ensure that our students are successful i also defer to you know dr grimes who's a you know sitting superintendent right now if you'd like to you know provide any additional comments around that i definitely don't want to take the floor from our council members thank you i would just add to the comments our fearless leader just made is that i also see this work has been connected to other initiatives and opportunities that are going on the board recently approved the revision or the

[00:55:25] addition of cultural responsiveness being a focus for teacher evaluation process and so as we begin to look at not just opening the door for students but also ensuring that they do have those supports in place and what do they look like but it also has to culminate in really looking at our processes and our practices and that starts with the folks in the classrooms and and really um digging up and upsetting and overturning and examining and restructuring how we approach our students how we the lens through which we view them their past achievements uh and their abilities and

[00:56:03] possibilities when we do open the door and provide the equity of access to the opportunity absolutely dr grimes and i want to also uh you know turn it over to uh leah walker who could you know provide us additional support who guided all of us through this process. Leah. So thank you Roshard. What I guess the only comment I would add to what's been shared already Dr. Paxton as it relates to your question is sort of two thoughts. First and foremost the Virginia standards and the SOA already established clear expectations around support for students who are identified as gifted

[00:56:41] and have access to advanced course placements right so like that minimum establishment around expectations exist one of the problems that we're seeing is that the gatekeepers and the gates and the and the artificial um sort of policies that are put in place that limit access for many many students particularly those who have been traditionally marginalized in public schools so i'd start there and then

secondly um i think as as staff when we think about how this gets operationalized and um institutionalized from from our work in our lens at the department level

[00:57:16] we think about these things um as layering on top of the other work we're already doing so the board will will vote tomorrow on new uniform professional standards which includes a cultural competency and equity standard which embeds within that the expectation around meeting the support providing the supports and meeting the needs of all students and so when you couple that with removing barriers that are providing limited access for certain students those things begin to work in concert with each other and then we embed within that again right the layer of

[00:57:51] accountability to that expectation and so um i wouldn't say that um we have to do these things in like a sequential order but i think we should recognize that all of these things do build upon each other to produce the equitable outcomes and access the opportunity that we want to see for all of our students thank you for that perspective that very uh very helpful just kind of filling in some gaps for me and it's very obvious that you you guys are connecting those dots right and and recognizing like like how you said it doesn't have to be a sequential approach really needs to be a

[00:58:27] comprehensive approach and and targeting the things that are have the most limitations on our children and those are the gates a lot of the gates right dr man i want to join dr man just Thank you all for this incredible presentation today and two things that struck me.

[00:58:52] One was just the identification of how much representation is associated with future choices that students of color make. The whole idea of actually experiencing a diverse educator being associated with students being more likely to pursue post-secondary education.

[00:59:15] I mean, those stats were stunning. They were just absolutely stunning and they underscore a significant need for us to really work hard at diversifying the workforce.

[00:59:31] And so connected to that, I took note of your recommendations around the praxis and the opportunity to consider micro credentials or other ways other pathways to support being able to access more diverse educators and it honestly made me think back to the presentation we had before and I the technical edits around

[01:00:04] requiring on the CTE side an and over an or in favor of rigor for the seal. I didn't speak out loud about it then, but I recognize that that is like another rule that could unintentionally create a disproportional outcome where it's not necessary, right? Earning a B or passing an exam,

[01:00:37] why aren't those things both considered sufficient for recognizing the accomplishments of students and so i i think the things you put on the table for us to contemplate around this are just they do call for a bit of boldness around how hard we want to fight to change things because we are not serving all students well with the rules we create that limit access and i i speak

[01:01:12] as a parent who had a son who matriculated through a public school district in our state who um had not gone through a gifted track identified you know second grade third grade and had opportunities to sort of perceive of himself in that way and yet when he got to high school because it was open access to ib courses and his own motivation around his desire to want to pursue that path he didn't

[01:01:46] have to worry about do i need to score a certain way i i just i think the things that you are inviting us to contemplate we have to really we have to say the time has come to go harder at this so I

thank you for um coming before us and and putting this out here. He did earn an IB diploma uh at the end of the day because his desire and his motivation was for that and I just feel like

[01:02:19] we have got to create conditions where that lives in many many many many more places around the the commonwealth so thank you yes dr wilson thank you dr pexton um mr wright dr grimes mr hunt secretary dyke thank you all very much for being here there are a couple of things that i would just observe one is as we listen to the presentation there is an alignment a clear alignment in the record largely the recommendations that are coming from the council to the work that the board has

[01:02:58] been doing over the last several years so there are resonant areas there's a consistency and i think it's important to acknowledge that that this is something that has we've been talking about it talking about it and now here's another opportunity to think about how we begin to wrap the pieces together and move the needle forward the other thing that i was going to just affirm is dr

[01:03:27] man's observation about the value in thinking differently about existing processes structures models all of those things yes there may be opportunity to to really um introduce something brand new but even thinking about the structures that are already in place and thinking about the or as opposed to the and is i think opportunities that we as a board need to

[01:04:01] continue to take and i appreciate dr lane and the department staff particularly for unpacking those things in ways that provides us something more to think about and certainly leah's work around ed equity va and all of that effort we are seeing the impact of that here in the recommendations so thank you all very much and i had had the opportunity to sit with the group as it's done its work and so i appreciate the comment about the level of detail that

[01:04:35] has gone into it i observed that firsthand for certain dr dron thank you i also want to commend everyone who presented today but a special accommodation to miles you did an amazing job on presenting thank you for that um my question and i want to echo all the comments of all my

[01:04:56] My question, Dr. Sale or maybe Dr. Lane, can you speak with us a little bit more about the one specific recommendation as it relates to the school climate indicator and any of the work and the discussion that's being thought of right now by the department on how we might be able to, in the context of this special committee on SOAs, think about applying that towards any revision there.

[01:05:23] I'll jump in on that, Dr. Sale and Leah, and feel free to correct me or add anything to it. I think that the board has looked at this through now two SOA revisions in 2017 and now again. And in 2017, ultimately the decision was made that we didn't really have a great tool for that. Since that time there's been a lot of work between DCJS and the Department of Ed to consolidate the school climate survey, which I think going into this SOA revision was our initial thinking around how you might create an indicator on that. I will say the

[01:06:02] African American Superintendents Advisory Council has really given us a different way to think about that with some of the indexing and other ways to look at that. And so they just finalized their recommendations last week. So we maybe have a few days of lead on this and certainly we help them formulate some of those thoughts. But I think we need to spend some time as a department and think about how indexing some of that will look and what types of indicators are actually in the survey uh before i can make a formal recommendation so i see this as a starting point not necessarily an ending point for your deliberation yeah and i would just add that we have some free work on this and

[01:06:42] that we did add to the next school climate survey um new questions that do get at assessing racial climate um and racial um sort of sense of belonging and inclusion in schools from the student perspective um that those were new additions that were added um sort of last year sometimes so for the next administration of the survey those questions will be included and so again as dr lane stated um i think we need more time to think about what an index potentially would look like but we have done some of the pre-leg work and at least um adding those questions

[01:07:18] that kind of get at some of that to prepare for more detailed conversations such as this. Thank you Leah and Dr. Lane and Dr. Pexton you always ask you know what are some things that our committee should put forth the next steps or things we'd like to dig deep and I hope that we can add this to that conversation as we move forward in terms of recommendations. I think that shared today with our school climate indicator is one that we should really look deep that is as a special committee i think the value the need of how it was presented

[01:07:57] and the impact that we could have as a result of it being a part of that would be very helpful thank you dr dr paxton yeah i've uh yes uh miss davis fought and just real quick i know that i've i've not been keeping up with the raised hand feature i've been told so for those of you who have your hands raised i will get to you but miss davis bought you're you're up next yes that's okay well i would like to echo the sentiments of my colleagues on the board and mr wright members of the team who came to present today i'd like to just say one more time i would commend you for

[01:08:32] your work i commend you for your passion and thank you very much for speaking with us today and i would also like to do a shout out to leah too because she and all of her teammates have been doing such a fantastic job that they are receiving national attention and leah will be presenting next week on the NASB legislative conference coming up. I forget the name of the subgroup, but I'm Leah. Thank you very much for everything that you're doing and agreeing to do that.

[01:09:04] So something that was mentioned that just caught my ear and I'm curious, and I don't know if this is to Dr. Lane or Dr. Sale or to the council, but I'm wondering, you made a recommendation about ideas surrounding redoing zoning the rezoning in districts so i'd like to hear a little bit more about that and your thoughts where you would like to go with that i'll take that on so during our time together on that particular subgroup really just acknowledged some of the you know potentially

[01:09:44] intended or unintended disparities that come out of zoning while we know a number of school divisions across Virginia um you know have neighborhood schools but you you also have opportunities for for magnets and uh you know to be uh you know to be provided an opportunity to attend you know a school maybe on the other side of town but there's still challenges um and you know this could go back to research around redlining you know would that still be something that's relevant in some of our school divisions uh here in Virginia so again it's to elevate the conversation and again local school boards would have to you know follow up based on guidelines

[01:10:22] we would recommend and provide them but zoning did come up in our work yeah and if i could just chime in here putting on another hat uh uh mcguire woods which i'm a part put out a report you probably saw something in the press a few weeks ago in richmond times dispatch looking at the issue of zoning and segregation in virginia and just like virginia had massive resistance that denied equal educational opportunity initially a lot of our virginia localities and the state affirmatively had segregated housing the redlining the whole nine yards

[01:11:00] and once that was declared unconstitutional they moved to use zoning as a way of separating people out and not allowing full integration of housing and you can't talk about neighborhood schools without talking about integrated neighborhoods and that's an issue that's broader than the board of education quite honestly and we've taken it to the general assembly and to the business community and we're going to be working awfully hard at that level to begin to address it but there clearly is a educational component to having segregated zoning in fact i think vcu there was a

[01:11:36] study that came out of vcu a few months ago and a few other places that looked at the tie the direct time between uh housing segregation and the quality of educational opportunity that was presented so that's a big issue but the voice of the board of education saying this is important general assembly governor business community you have to address this would be very very helpful so i'm glad you raised that point thank you gentlemen thank you miss fought and just for awareness i'm

[01:12:09] gonna go to dr roberson then miss holton and then i believe uh dan i'm not quite sure if you had a question or thought but we'll start with Ms. Hulton. I'm sorry Dr. Roberson. Thank you Dr.

[01:12:28] Paxton. I commented earlier since this is my first meeting as a state board member I don't know if I'm supposed to remain quiet throughout the meetings but I recognize it's a very friendly group and one that really is inspiring me to have some thoughts and to share them briefly. First I want to say that the members of the council could not be more awesome it is a council from whom or individuals from whom i have over the years and continue to derive much inspiration

[01:13:04] from them all and the leadership they provide today and not only across the commonwealth but also in helping all of us think about uh any number of items and and new ways is is uh very valuable to all of us and i i appreciate the fact that the state superintendent put the council together it was a very very smart move and i can't imagine uh coming into my first meeting of any organization and facing a more powerful set of recommendations uh it's it's really uh engaging

[01:13:42] enlightening and creates a lot of opportunity to think about the potential for the difference the board can make and i thank you all for the recommendations which have been formed um my um my one observation about one of the recommendations is uh probably uh too detailed too technical but it pertains uh to the evaluation of the master schedules and it also i think builds off of what dr mann gave as a personal example there may have been a conscious reason to

[01:14:20] ensure equitable student assignment and honors slash advanced and ap courses as the language i would suggest that ib courses should probably be highlighted or stipulated in that same sentence so that you are covering the the waterfront of those higher end opportunities i don't know though if the uh if the council had a reason for not incorporating ib perhaps it was assumed that it was an honors or advanced course but i would i would suggest that it be highlighted or maybe

[01:14:57] that's something that the board can take on uh when it comes to the board and it can be advised there. As a point of personal privilege, can I just say, Stuart, I feel your pain. I remember my first school board of education activity when I joined, and I'm dating myself, 1985, was at the opening of the Thomas Jefferson High School in Fairfax, an issue that I know you guys are going to be addressing later. So I learned right from the beginning, you've got to speak up right from the first at the beginning. So I'm sure you'll follow through on that,

[01:15:32] that knowing of your great history and education. - Yeah, and I'll add to that with the significance of this discussion, whether it's your first meeting or your last, everyone should have something to say 'cause this is a conversation that we all need to be talking about.

[01:15:51] So very good, Ms. Holton. - Yeah, thank you, Keisha, and thank you all. What a great presentation today. I agree with Tammy, some of that data is just really shocking and really brings home uh the importance of addressing this work i also uh have looked at your letter that's part of our public comment uh um from the council and you all did a great job there in presenting some really concrete suggestions and i see in addition to the climate indicator suggestion there are

[01:16:26] suggestions that we consider indicators around a diversity index an opportunity and access indicator and you give us an example of some other state that's created one and i think that's one I'd be really interested in knowing more about a discipline indicator.

[01:16:44] I just want to toss one thought out, and maybe you all have some reaction to it. And sorry, sorry, I've got some conflicting thing going on here. There. We are revising the SOA's now sort of midstream. And I'm sorry, let me see if I can't figure out what's making this other noise.

[01:17:21] I'm sorry. Okay, I made it go away. We're in the middle of a sort of a midstream correction on the standards of accreditation. We're not, I think, looking now at huge changes because the standards that we put into place haven't been in effect long enough to have results and adequate feedback from the field.

[01:17:47] And yet we're realizing there may be things that need to be changed. And that's what Dr. Pexton's committee is looking at. But I raised this because one of my frustrations with our current setup, which I very much endorsed and helped us get there, but our current setup is one where basically every new indicator is a way for schools to fail.

[01:18:08] We don't have a system right now where there are some carrots and sticks. It's all just, so for instance, if we put in a discipline indicator, that's a new way for schools and divisions to fail to meet accreditation standards.

[01:18:28] And I don't know what the answer on that is, but until we change that big structure, which I don't think is happening here. I worry that every time we do a new indicator, we have to think about it anyway, is it just gonna pick on the same schools that are already being picked on because they aren't able to succeed because they haven't partly because of resource issues and or because they're serving our toughest community, our neediest communities.

[01:18:58] So for instance, a discipline indicator may well just, penalize the same schools and school divisions that are currently penalized under academic indicators, again, without adequate resources to address these issues.

[01:19:17] So I just say that to say, if you guys have got any ideas for how do we help indicators be a positive pull, not a punitive push, and or, you know, and I guess another question would be of the various indicators you recommend and you've talked about quite a few you know which would be the most important and which do you think might avoid that problem of picking on the same uh just highlighting needs i shouldn't say picking on highlighting needs at the same schools that are already highlighted as between an opportunity and access indicator a discipline

[01:19:55] indicator a diversity index indicator or climate do you have any thoughts on which of those you would like us to work on first if that's an approach we try to take. Ms. Houlton, if I could try to answer the first part of your question and then maybe let Mr.

[01:20:12] Wright answer the second part of your question. In terms of thinking through sort of the impact of adding additional indicators to accountability or to our accreditation system, I think that when we think about equity and we think about applying an equity lens to the way in which we so systematically provide a system of public education one of the things that you'll notice when we when we crafted our ed equity ba plan was that we really looked at inputs outcomes are an effect of the inputs that are in the system but we don't measure those inputs all

[01:20:49] the time and so if we're looking at academic achievement gap with a failure to recognize or measure the impact of exclusionary discipline practices that disproportionately are affecting certain student groups but yet we're holding schools accountable only for the academic achievement gap that they are not achieving we're missing an opportunity to apply the support and identify the areas of support that are necessary to impact that outcome the other part of it is that when we look at our data and we see that there are only five school divisions in the state of Virginia

[01:21:25] that do not have a significant amount of disproportionality as it relates to school discipline disposition for black students this is a statewide issue and it's it's data that we've been measuring for many many many many years and not seeing any movement in the right direction on the disparate impact in particular it's how particular that it's having on black students And so, you know, I'll let Rashard speak more to what is the priority of ASAC.

[01:21:57] You know, I think probably they're all priorities, but of course, you know, we might not be able to do everything at one time. But what I would say is that I really do think that if we want to think about our work and the purpose of accountability and apply that equity lens, then we have to start holding to account and measuring and monitoring things other than outputs and really start looking at inputs as well.

[01:22:20] and uh before uh mr wright goes i he and i chatted and i i told him i'd jump in first and he was fine with it um i also think that there are ways that you can structure accountability without impacting big a accreditation so you know as an example you could create an indicator and like with school improvement anything that's level three has to have a corrective action plan but not every time that you get a level three does it mean you're not accredited right and so i think that there are ways to to hold schools accountable for that without it

[01:22:53] necessarily meaning the school won't you know or will face this very public shaming of accreditation so that that's just a thought to think through uh mr wright priorities yeah sure so i'll just say secretary holton we we believe these four areas um if we can make that a focus um will truly support all of our current state success indicators. So when we think about climate, when we think about discipline and the academic performance of our students here in Virginia, regardless of rural, urban, and suburban, you know, for instance, achievement gaps persist because of the lack

[01:23:32] of opportunity, right? So that's why we're focusing on opportunity gaps. If we continue to diversify our teacher force, because we know that I think less than 20 percent of our teachers our minority in the state of Virginia, our minority students and our minoritized students are definitely in a place where they can see themselves in the teaching setting, in the learning setting. And ultimately, we know that

culturally relevant practices and being culturally competent as an educator will allow students to feel that connection and allow students to know

[01:24:08] that they are in a place where they can be successful. Also, making that commitment and having the board whether again it's just the beginning commit to this work and and not just hold school divisions accountable but again elevate that conversation we should see all of our existing success criteria we should see all of them increase so it's not just about you know do we need to change how we look at climate um absolutely we need to change how we look at discipline but we believe that these four areas will put us in the best position to work on being a lot more successful for all of our students in the state of Virginia.

[01:24:46] Yeah I agree and I just want to add that I think when we're looking at the indicators discipline is a big issue that's going to prohibit students from having opportunities or even achievement. So the data speaks for itself 22 percent of total student enrollment that includes our black students but they make up 50 52 percent of all students suspended so we really should look at discipline but again as Mr. Wright said I feel like they are all intertwined and they are all very important that's why we presented it today miles somebody's going to offer you a job as an

[01:25:24] as an administrator as an educator before you even head off the college young man appreciate your voice so much and i'll talk and i'll talk to him about which of our fine public institutions in virginia you can go to the next step we'll all fight for you fight over you uh well thank you that was all very helpful and i i do think the notion of trying to figure out how to uh elevate the discussion around these indicators without necessarily having it have punitive consequences i mean i just think the diversity index is one great example where our

[01:25:59] school divisions that are serving the most black and brown kids are going to be potentially penalized you know school divisions at least the way that diversity index you you linked us to measures you know if you don't have any black and brown kids you don't have to have so many black and brown faculty at least the way that indicator works because it's the gap between the two that it measures and so there's just a lot of nuance here and and i just worry that you know my petersburgs and richmond's of the world get declared a failure every which way um because they are serving um the neediest kids with uh disproportionately relative to the need less

[01:26:39] resources and so i'm just real conscious of this but but but having a way to elevate the discussion absolutely that you're you're right that the discipline is a great example of one that's absolutely all across the state so uh i'd like to give dan an opportunity i appreciate that dr pexton uh since almost everything that could be said has been said i'll actually be uh relatively brief i did want to thank everybody on that panel for the excellent presentation you know it's nothing as exciting you know the day before a full board meeting has to be pumped up about the work we're

[01:27:15] doing so i appreciate greatly you know the focus and the detail that went into it i also appreciate you know dr wilson pointing out that you know some of the things that we're talking about here are things that the board has in focus and it ought not be lost that uh you know we're not new to this we're actually in a sense almost old to it you know i know some people express shock over these numbers but the truth is that we've known these numbers for a long time right i mean we've seen in the press, the discipline numbers for years. We've known about the achievement gap for what, 20 years, 20 plus years, you know, a long time. And the question really comes down to, I

[01:27:54] think, as Secretary Dice started to indicate, what are we going to do about it? You know, a couple of years ago, and I will get around to a very specific question for the committee. A couple of years ago, our board, you know, as part of our comprehensive work plan, actually for the first time in two decades prescribed standards of quality and secretary dyke you referenced them as you know additional funding which i appreciate and also you know as for the full funding of it which i also appreciate you know but something that gets lost there sometimes is the change in

[01:28:27] policy that's evidenced by the board's prescribed soq's compared to the current legislature past soq's and specifically a couple areas that have been very near and dear to my heart, in particular the one you referenced in your letter to us, the equitable distribution of teachers, is a policy change that's really embodied in the standards of quality prescribed by the board, but has absolutely gained no traction in the legislature. It would be nice if I could take a tape of or a

[01:29:03] recording i don't know if tape is just pegs me as an old guy but a recording of uh secretary dykes you know charged to the group uh about what did we do you know when the time came and take it to all the legislators we go see but one of the things i would like to ask of the group is that uh my guess is we will for a third time prescribe soqs in the fall uh to the extent that you would be willing to participate in the lobbying effort with our state legislators uh that is how policy gets changed you know i'm a firm believer that the marker that has been put out there which as i said

[01:29:40] includes a fair amount of the things that you're looking at is a good one and over time though you know the legislature will bend toward that marker but i think we can accelerate that time frame with a more concerted effort and to the extent your group is willing to help out in that effort you know we would certainly appreciate it uh second and a specific request of your group uh you reference two recommendations for soq changes you know it's my belief that most of the policy that the board gets to do really is reflected in those soqs and i guess between the soas and the soqs a

[01:30:15] lot of the policy that we can impact is accomplished to the extent that you believe there are other things we can do through the soqs or frankly changes to the prescribed soqs that you think ought to be made to make them more equitable in application. I would appreciate that kind of review. As I said, I believe item two on your recommendations is included. I certainly think we will consider seriously the first request for culturally responsive and inclusive practices coordinators in each division. But there's got to be something else here that we can look at

[01:30:50] and put in this document, which as you know, all of you know, controls the funding and therefore the policy of the commonwealth with regard to this you know third and final point i would like to you know just mention that the issue with regard to division lines and uh sort of the frankly the grouping of socioeconomically poor people uh or disadvantaged people uh has been clearly in focus uh we are struggling i am struggling honestly because this is an area

[01:31:26] that i would like to see us do more work on we have done work uh to demonstrate for example that schools with a higher preponderance or proportion of lower socioeconomic uh status children have got a higher percentage significantly higher about twice the percentage of uh either first-year teachers or teachers teaching outside their endorsed area which goes to one of the points i think you make i have yet to come up with though and you know honestly have spent a lot of time on this how do we measure it how do we demonstrate uh you know what the issue is and in in terms of

[01:32:05] how we can implement a change on the ground i mean put aside for a minute the constitutional issue of whether we can do it that is or whether the locals have to do it just put that aside for a minute uh assume we could do it what would it look like i mean i've seen some of the work product that suggests well if you just merge divisions you can do it but then you get into the reality of you've got a bus elementary kids you know an hour and a half in order to achieve the racial balance that you're looking to achieve not realistic necessarily you know on the ground as it is in

[01:32:39] the academic paper and so i i'm not asking for an answer today but as we move forward this is work that our board is undertaking you know it is uh you know jamel and i talk every other week this This is one of the items on the standing list of where this board is headed.

[01:32:58] Not only intra-division, but inter-division, because it is our charge to measure the impact of division lines on the fulfillment of the standards of quality. That is one we clearly have purview over. But more minds are better than fewer minds, to the extent you have thoughts about how to do this practically, boy, I'd really appreciate them, because it is an area I'd like to see us focus on.

[01:33:24] it. Keisha, thank you for letting me talk. We really do appreciate the work that you're doing, and I look forward to doing some really important things with you together as we move forward. If I could respond quickly to that, a couple of points. First, I'll start with the last point on a personal matter. You talk about the busing and all that sort of thing. I grew up in Prince George's county maryland back when the schools were segregated and we because of limitation of

[01:33:56] housing opportunities we lived on a farm in a part of prince george's county uh and because we could only go to two black schools i had to ride a school bus past several schools to get to where i'm going but not only that i had to catch a greyhound bus and ride for four or five miles to catch the school bus to go to those schools so zoning has a serious impact on on on the educational opportunity which you mentioned but to go back to your first point this council will stand with you and go talk to the legislators i for one will commit to do that and one of the

[01:34:35] things i would urge you uh one of my other hats was to have the workforce education effort at the virginia state chamber in developing the blueprint for virginia and the number one issue in the business community is workforce education workforce preparation education the board needs to reach out and work with the business community to go with you to the general assembly because they've got a vested interest in making sure that we address issues like teacher diversity and the other issues that we've been talking about right here because that's going to be the preparation of the

[01:35:12] future workforce for virginia and growing our economy and so it's not just the board of education that needs to go there we need to have allies standing next to you saying what you're advocating is absolutely important it's essential if we're going to grow virginia's economy and i would urge you and the board and i'm volunteering on behalf of the council and also on the state chamber we're ready to go with you to make that effort and to be full partners with you because we're all invested in making sure this happens i'll just thank you very much i mean i do look forward to

[01:35:49] doing this. Thank you. You know, as the board knows, moving these SOQs and the concepts embodied therein is just tremendously important to all of us and to the future. And so the help we get from you, I know we'll be instrumental in making this happen. Thank you. Yeah. And you've got good businesses that are willing to go with you. I'm looking at your committee chair, Ms. Paxton, what Newport News shipbuilding has done in the whole area of apprenticeship and education and promotion of the

importance of this is absolutely essential to have them standing next to you when you go talk to the General Assembly, and that will get their attention.

[01:36:27] Legislators will listen when the business community says this is important. We just had a similar conversation at Newport News Shipbuilding yesterday about how we need to be rallying together around regionalism in a different way, one of them being like you just suggested, Secretary Dyke. So for the sake of time, I do believe Mr. Swan and maybe Dr. Roberson and might have wanted to add a couple of comments.

[01:36:49] So I was gonna allow them to add comments if they still had them. And then I'm gonna go ahead and transition after those two comments into our next presentation 'cause I wanna give them time, which continues the conversation. So if you do have some additional thoughts after that, you'll be able to do so at the end of that presentation. But Mr. Swan, did you have any thoughts or questions?

[01:37:08] - Yes. So I too have the privilege of working on the council and I support these recommendations. speaking from a current classroom teacher and just seeing things on the front lines myself.

[01:37:24] If we have more of our schools that are culturally competent, it will also help with the discipline. For instance, just this week, we had a new student to enter our building on Monday. And because he didn't have a culturally competent teacher, I feel, she wrote him up his very first day.

[01:37:47] And he was an African-American student. I've heard my counterparts say things like, about our African-American students, they'll say, but they're nothing but a hoodlum or they're never gonna be anything. So I support the teacher diversity as well.

[01:38:05] Having those micro-credentials could be very important and detrimental and it will change the face of education in order to get more African-American teachers. Speaking from experience, It took me three times to pass the praxis.

[01:38:21] And had I not had the determination, I probably would have quit because each time you have to pay for that test. And so have these recommendations in place will also help with the discipline. Another success story, even in my school, when I started Guys with Ties, our African-American disciplinary rate was at 69%.

[01:38:43] Once I started the Guys with Ties program, it dropped to 22%. so having that diversity in teaching, it will help with the discipline. So I can speak from that.

[01:39:01] - Great, thank you for sharing your thoughts, Mr. Schwann. Dr. Roberson, do you have any final comments, question? - Well, again, perhaps because my rookie status, I was impartful in asking my question. I was actually asking the question toward the end of my comments previously, and that was, does the council have any issue concern about incorporating IB with AP courses for this master schedule review? Was there any conversation about that? Is there any concern if the board was to revise your recommendation to add IB to that? No, I think it was inclusive in advanced programs or advanced courses.

[01:39:40] We didn't specifically call it out, but it was certainly within the philosophical thinking of the council i might recommend that we that we stipulate it but we can take that up tomorrow i think we don't have an issue with that richard no issue at all thank you thank you okay so with that we'll go ahead and continue on with our our final presentation for the afternoon uh which will

[01:40:15] be promoting equity in the standards of accreditation and we have uh dr leslie sale and leah walker our Director of Equity and Community Engagement as our next presenters. And so their presentation is going to continue to better help us understand how AASAC's recommendations can be integrated into our current accountability system.

[01:40:36] So Leslie and Leah, I will turn it over to you. - Wonderful, well, I will go ahead and kick us off. And kind of the way that I wanted this presentation to work would be to be kind of more of a dialogue format. So if we certainly will have time for questions and comments at the end, but if folks want to pipe in and contribute to the conversation, and I'm sure Leah will as well, 'cause she has the context and information behind so much of this work that her input here will be valuable.

[01:41:09] But I do wanna say that this presentation, like the one before it, just to give a little bit of context, focuses on how the board can support and prioritize racial equity in its work. And whereas the AASAC presenters really emphasize the necessity of the proposed work and the why behind it.

[01:41:29] The purpose of our complimentary presentation here is really meant to start us thinking in about how to connect these thematic sets of action items to some of our existing levers for change specifically in the board standards of accreditation. And obviously from the discussion that's already happened before us, we are already in that mind space.

[01:41:48] So this conversation will suit us well, but did wanna just kind of give us a framework for us to continue that thought process and thought exercise. A few preface items for the discussion today, because of this group's charge, I will say that these slides primarily consider how we're leveraging the SOA in particular, but as our conversation has already noted and the scale of the, and kind of scope of recommendations that are coming from the ASC go far beyond this.

[01:42:19] I'd be remiss to say that, you know, this isn't an indication of all the work to be done. So of course, what we heard from the AASAC members will still rely on some of the board's, others' authorities and discretion, but I hope that this particular presentation is a helpful start in mobilizing around some of those recommendations specific to the standards of accreditation, but again, doesn't necessarily capture all the work that's to be done.

[01:42:48] And I will also say that I kind of imagine presentation is a mapping exercise of sorts but I say that recognizing that not every recommendation is going to have a perfect overlay to an existing lever so some of the more dynamic recommendations we will see can be addressed through more than one lever and using some different mechanisms in the standards of accreditation or we may even find some of the recommendations can be segmented to employ multiple levers to accomplish the the same kind of outcome or destination here.

[01:43:22] So the slides that follow are not designed to submit our approach and moving forward but again just to get us thinking about the menu of opportunity here and that of course recognizes that you all are still each digesting the recommendations to come from from the letter and the presentation today and organizing your own thinking and I will just say from my personal perspective the discussion that we already have has been formative for my thinking um so some of this may already be outdated and how we want to imagine how we um you know execute and implement some of these recommendations um and lastly i think a really critical and important part of the

[01:43:59] discussion is linking our action to accountability um and that can be both in terms of as dr lane mentioned our big a accountability system being accreditation but also those interrelated components and those little a accountability measures that exist within the soa so with that and and kind of moving forward with this lens of accountability i just wanted to quickly revisit our accountability structures in virginia from that 30 000 foot view and as you all might recall from a presentation earlier in the committee's work there are a few different facets of virginia

[01:44:35] accountability which of course includes our state accreditation system and our school quality profiles um the latter of which provide a reporting and transparency mechanism as part of our virginia accountability system but as we dig in a little bit further um the soa and and sqp as we imagine them in the virginia accountability kind of sphere and universe are separate components because they have unique functions but all of these pieces are related and in fact um just kind of wanted to recognize that the school quality profiles are in fact embedded in our standards of accreditation

[01:45:14] And alongside that, and from what we know of other and from our past presentations, there are a number of other components of the SOA that can serve as levers for change. Again, using both that little A understanding of accountability and then as they relate to our big A accountability system, which is accreditation here.

[01:45:34] And one of the things I particularly like about this slide is that these levers that we recognize here actually span four of the eight parts of the standards of accreditation, which I think really speaks to the applicability of a number of different strategies that we can think.

[01:45:52] So our ability to be creative and how we employ the standards of accreditation and mobilizing around these recommendations. So beginning chronologically, I want to start us with part three, which includes a number of our substantive pieces of the standards of accreditation, and I think most notably here for us is the section on graduation requirements.

[01:46:16] And the importance and value of graduation requirements, I think, is fairly obvious to all of us, but it's also helpful to think about them as two sides of the same coin. So graduation requirements certainly reinforce student expectations that are aligned with profile of the Virginia graduate and consequently the Virginia diploma which is the result of completing all of the graduation requirements are designed to set students up for success in their post-secondary endeavors. But they also create for us a shared expectation for the types and variety of course offerings that schools must provide. So we have a component of student and school

[01:46:53] expectation when we think about our graduation requirements. I will quickly note that our graduation requirements are considered a prerequisite for accreditation and i'm actually going to keep you on the edge of your seat here and not dig into what that means just yet because i think it will come together at the end of the presentation and we'll actually see that phrase come up in a few different slides but it's worth noting and us keeping top of mind as we move forward and think about all of the different ways again we can leverage the standards of accreditation

[01:47:24] so here you'll have some of the the recommendations from the aasac committee members that we felt related to graduation requirements i'm not going to read this slide to you um because these bullets were pulled largely verbatim from the the aasac letter and i did that very intentionally to make sure that i maintain the integrity of the recommendations here um and as you can see some of the aasac

recommendations listed here explicitly asked the board to reconsider our graduation requirements but also ways to support students in becoming career and workforce ready

[01:48:02] and so these are some of the recommendations that we see being addressed potentially through graduation requirements because they ensure access and exposure to types of coursework that we know build the knowledge skills and competencies we we know to be critical in post-secondary endeavors if i could just add here some just additional context for consideration by by the board, while the language that ASAC recommended officially to the board was brought in somewhat general in terms of your consideration, these recommendations really stand out of

[01:48:38] conversations specifically related to the necessity for Virginia to continue to have two separate diplomas. That was really where the conversation started was the evaluation of the disparate data around the different diploma types that students were achieving, particularly the gap in achievement of advanced diploma versus standard diploma for African American students.

[01:49:04] And so I wanted to just provide that additional context for your awareness as you think about how the actual recommendation was framed and consider future deliberations on this topic. Thank you, Leah.

[01:49:19] I appreciate that additional context. Moving forward, so part four of the standards of accreditation are where we start to set out the expectations for all of Virginia Public Schools instructional programs.

[01:49:37] And I will say that there is a general instructional program section, as well as specific ones that are tailored to elementary, middle, and secondary schools respectively. So there are a few different sections that will be relevant for us here in this discussion.

[01:49:53] But these sections of the SOA particularly require schools to implement programs that align with the standards of learning and that highlight key instructional areas of emphasis that includes core courses scientific concepts and processes concepts of citizenship world languages health mpe the arts career and exploration and investigation so there's a pretty big operational space in and what we're imagining for our instructional programs and what we want to emphasize in these spaces so additionally these sections also set out learning objectives that

[01:50:28] support the profile of a virginia graduate and it ensures that students are acquiring certain knowledge skills and competencies that include the five c's and again we're going to see that phrase prerequisite of accreditation here but important for us to acknowledge that this is one of the sections that will also interplay later in our discussion here around compliance and and the big a accreditation and accountability system so again mapping some of our aasac recommendations over to our instructional programmatic requirements that live in the soa um and i think this is where

[01:51:04] we start to see and and it's kind of exemplary of some of those recommendations that are going to have application in multiple areas of the soa so as we consider what we want schools to provide and we want students to have exposure to or at the very least access to um we may want to think about these different items as expectations for students and/or schools, and that will help us inform the way we might translate some of these recommendations to changes in the SOA. And Leah, I will actually pause there in case there's any additional context for this kind of group of recommendations, but if

[01:51:43] not, I'm happy to keep moving forward. Yeah, I know why you paused. So we were having earlier discussion about this. So one of the things that I think is important to consider as we're thinking about changes or revisions to the SOA to advance equity is that one of the sort of um foundational tenets of equity work is that it provides um transparency for all stakeholders and so when we um as a staff were really thinking about what what are the the different sort of levers and points within the SOA where some of these recommendations could be embedded we really got into a discussion

[01:52:20] about um the value of putting it in places that create the greatest amount of transparency for all the interested stakeholders which would include parents families educators not just right school leaders and the board of education and so i wanted to just provide that additional context as you're considering where there are opportunities to potentially embed a recommendation either in the programmatic section or in the compliance section or as a prerequisite that we think about

[01:52:53] the necessity to create the transparency around the requirement and the the division or school or educators ability to meet the requirement thank you oh absolutely uh so moving on to part seven of the standards of accreditation which is where we set out the requirements for school and community communications and this includes the responsibility to make certain data publicly accessible and this is actually where we start to see the reference to our school quality profiles

[01:53:32] and the school quality profiles being a part of the standards of accreditation so even though we think of them as different mechanisms they are are interrelated and kind of build on one another here because the sqp is part of the standards of accreditation and so within this group's purview here um i did also want to acknowledge that there are other means that we have for making data transparent um for example you know publicly posting on the department of education website um and so as we consider reporting structures there may be some logistical and practical considerations um that we keep in mind but um i think the again the key takeaway here is is making

[01:54:10] sure that we're making certain pieces of data available and and very publicly visible here so again not to read through the individual bullets um but i think these are the the recommendations that that kind of particularly spoke to this reporting component and visualizing how students are paired with which teachers and the opportunity gaps that exist in our public school system and these are ways through the reporting structure that we can hold schools accountable in their practices by making this this information and data again very readily available

[01:54:44] and visible um and that can be part of the sqp as it relates to the soa and beyond um as we think about other existing reporting structures um and then of course this is an opportunity as we think about identifying areas for change dr pexton could i ask a question here certainly i'm sorry to interrupt but just on this um a bullet here dr sale and ms walker i'm i believe that the idea is

[01:55:19] to identify to focus on the number of teachers of color compared to all students not the number of teachers of color to students of color is that is that correct correct i think the example that was provided was just to show how one state has thought about this um i don't think that's the way we would think about it in virginia uh because our work has really focused on all students benefit um having diversity um in their teaching faculty and so to miss holton's example earlier about a

[01:55:57] homogeneous school that may be all white you still want to see representation of teachers of color in that academic environment and so as we would think through how we would measure and report something like that we would want to make sure that we're capturing that as well just wanted to make sure

that we are very clear about what we're talking about here thank you thank you dr wilson and i appreciate um leah your your explanation there so we have finally gotten to our prerequisites

[01:56:31] for accreditation um the um the wait is over um and as we move into to part eight and and thinking about again using that big a of accountability and our accreditation mechanism here um there are two elements that i wanted to consider or put up for consideration for for the group here um the first being the prerequisites for accreditation and these are the items with which a school must certify before being eligible to even receive an accreditation rating and so something unique about that here is it adds an additional layer of compliance so for example the sections that we flagged as prerequisites for accreditations including graduation and

[01:57:11] instructional program requirements schools are actually have to indicate to us that they have met all of the the things that they need to do effectively to provide access to the coursework and have accomplished all of the things from the instructional program requirement side that would even make them eligible to receive accreditation so this is them committing to record that that they have fulfilled those responsibilities and structures and frameworks that we've created in the standards of accreditation um i will say that the um just quickly that the data reporting on the sqp is actually also a prerequisite for accreditation um i didn't

[01:57:48] highlight it in quite the same way that i did with the graduation requirements or programs of instruction because it is already so highly visible it already helps to kind of enforce compliance in and of itself but there are other features of the standards of accreditation that do have that compliance component to them and i think that was important to acknowledge and just for situational awareness for for the folks here the way that we do compliance is that school principals and division superintendents annually document and report to the department of education that they have met the prerequisites for accreditation as part of the standards of

[01:58:24] quality as part of the standards of quality compliance and other reporting data collection. So that happens during the summer and it becomes again kind of a way for us to capture information that schools have committed to fulfilling the framework of the standards of accreditation before they receive their accreditation rating. Because some of the SOA sections are also a part of the prerequisite for accreditation um i kind of wanted to expand on what leah noted there about how these two levers might be understood apart from one another um or and and how they could be

[01:59:00] kind of standalone recommendations or sections and vice versa um so depending on the type of requirement and the need for associated compliance structure there may be ways that we use these two kind of connected pieces of the SOA together or separately so for example here some of the recommendations that I included in this particular section around culturally relevant inclusive instructional content or having an equity plan for the or for each school by way of the division which was the recommendation of the AASC we may understand these as standalone compliance metrics

[01:59:36] or they may have companion elements in the instructional programs or even outside of the SOA so we're not kind of confined here again in our thinking that these are only parts of the prerequisites for accreditation but that does have that interrelated component with other segments and as Leah noted there is value in thinking about how to to use those other segments that really give the board and and you all more opportunity to flesh out concepts and really provide that sense of transparency so in the

compliance section you know we do indicate those things that that schools need to indicate to us prior to receiving the accreditation rating

[02:00:16] but the graduation requirements and instructional programs for example really talk more about you know what those individual requirements look like and really build them out in a substantive way which i think really translates to that transparency component for the folks who are or are end users of the standards of accreditation so our students parents schools divisions all of those and lee i don't know if there's anything that else that you wanted to kind of re-emphasize in that space. I think just some just additional context around the there was a very healthy and robust conversation amongst the ASAC around their recommendations that centered on

[02:00:55] mandates in compliance of the SOA and really that while there wasn't I won't say there was a hundred percent consensus because we did have some school board members on the ASAC who were really sensitive to maintaining local control there was also i think a great deal of general consensus though that in the absence of mandates at the state level to require some of these things the work becomes really difficult for leaders at the local level um sometimes to um get through their local school boards to do some of these things and so uh there was you know again some healthy conversation and

[02:01:33] uh definitely um allow dr wilson if she wants to to to share some of that as as sort of the she represented kind of our liaison between the board and asac but um there was a healthy conversation but ultimately the group did agree to use that stronger language around our mandate um feeling as though it really was going to be necessary in order for school leaders to move uh in the direction that they wanted to to go in so dr pexton just a very brief comment um

[02:02:06] Certainly, Leah has acknowledged what the challenge is, and for those of us who have served at division level, we recognize that there is a line between the role of the local board and the role of the state board and wanting to be very certain that as we, the state board, considers any requirements that we are understanding the line, but also the impact and the uh the differential across the state there are 132 school divisions

[02:02:44] and local school boards and each community is different and so understanding potential unintended consequences positive consequences as well as those unintended negative consequences that we may be creating and so just thinking about and having a very clear view of all of the perspectives that are at play as we consider requiring certain things of divisions or local boards and where that line is and certainly Mr. President Gecker alluded to some of that as he

[02:03:17] was talking about this notion of lines for school divisions or school attendance zones and so all of that conversation was at play the committee did or council did endorse this but the concerns are very real and i think are some that we would want to consider as we think about these recommendations so and and lastly um in addition to setting out our prerequisites for accreditation

[02:03:54] um part three also establishes as we now well know our state accreditation model and this is what rates our schools on a number of different school quality indicators including measures related to achievement graduation student progress student engagement and college and career readiness and this is really the basis for determining quality and effectiveness of schools and creating that means that drive continuous improvement um so i should note that in order to be considered as part of accreditation a school quality indicator must in and of itself meet certain criteria including its relationship to academic performance whether it

[02:04:34] can be modified by school level policies and practices but based on the how we've seen the use of data and the potential of the data we've collected as well as examples from other states we think there are some recommendations that may translate to school quality indicators and i think we're very clearly indicated as such in the aasac letter um so so probably no um surprises here and how we we kind of started to organize our thinking um and how recommendations might translate to different areas of the standards of accreditation.

[02:05:09] And I will not spend too much time since I know we're coming up against our four o'clock time anyways on the specifics of these different indicators and some of the examples that the AISC folks provided as examples for us to thank and start imagining these indicators. But if it's if it's helpful or worthwhile i'm sure i can provide some some high level context for those examples and i'm sure leah could certainly help help navigate us through the context and

[02:05:44] information behind it um and so with that i will i will open the floor back up to um leah and members of the committee and members of the aasac to continue the discussion um i will say i guess as a quick note before we jump in and something that i wanted to add for the board's consideration is there is one additional opportunity that i didn't didn't add to the discussion today and that is part two of the standards of accreditation where the board lays out its philosophy goals and objectives and so of course the emphasis of this presentation was to think about our opportunities

[02:06:21] for action and and as it relates to accountability and part two doesn't necessarily have quite as direct of a link um but i think this is a place where the the power of language of it and it's in and of itself is is pretty powerful so as we think about you know what we translate to um action and and different utilizing the different levers and the standards of accreditation um i might just ask the board so to continue to think about that opportunity to to reflect those priorities and changes in in that philosophy section um and just remind them that that that's there as an opportunity to make sure you know what we set out for the document and what it does are in alignment with

[02:07:01] one another so i will officially turn it over um to the to leah and the committee now for any questions or discussion and i just want to thank leslie for um all of her work to help us really think through how this gets operationalized and where it fits into the soa um and it's it's just always great to have a partner incline who can um take your ideas and make them into real things so So thank you, Leslie.

[02:07:28] - Good job. - Thank you, well, happy to be a part of it and happy to help continue that discussion going forward. - So thank you, Leslie and Leah for that presentation and just continuing to deepen our understanding about the potential connections to the work of the special committee and the standards as they are.

[02:07:52] I'm gonna open the floor up for questions, comments. I do see a comment in the chat box from Ms. Holton. don't know if you want to speak to that directly or if you just would like me to read it. I'll read it and let you speak to it. I don't understand adding requirements, SOLs to prerequisites for divisions. We at BOE write the SOLs, not the divisions. Yeah, I'll answer that one.

[02:08:20] I agree with Secretary Holden. I think we can address that through standards revisions and not necessarily in the soa but you you could even do something in that section two that leslie talked about to ensure that it's a priority so that as we update standards of learning that's done uh but i don't think that has to be done and prerequisite for sure okay any other thoughts or

[02:08:49] comments discussions from uh the committee or the any other board members in attendance didn't do so well with the whole hand raising thing before so i'm just making sure i'm not missing miss holton yes ma'am thank you keisha well i'll just reiterate something i was starting to get at earlier i i think these are a lot of really good suggestions i do think that the current version of the soas is better than what was before on equity measures and it was part of what we

[02:09:25] focused on as we did this the the 2017 revision of the soas but obviously we missed lots of important opportunities and there are lots of rooms to room to improve I would encourage the committee as part of this round of recommendations to be really focused on what are the what are the tools that are most going to advance the ball as part of an interim um adjustment and not to it well and to be careful to be wary of making too many changes in this interim mode unless

[02:10:02] while we're still giving divisions the chance to learn how the existing system works. So for instance, I think you're talking about adding, you know, if you're talking about adding four or five new indicators, I'm counting that many, that's a lot of work to get it right. And as we've seen, the nuance of how an indicator works, exactly how you measure it, that's just a lot to do, especially as part of interim revision. So I think the discipline one is incredibly important. I think

[02:10:36] if there is a good measure of opportunity gaps that would be a great one or if some of those indicators could be better dealt with elsewhere. I think the diversity index on faculty is incredibly important and yet I actually think the bigger barriers to hiring diverse faculty may be elsewhere you know in teacher pay in uh methods of attracting and retaining strong teachers which we've tried to address through our soq soq recommendations about teacher coaching etc maybe through revisions that are within our control on the licensing praxis etc

[02:11:16] so i don't know which of these would be best addressed as part of soa revisions or if you know or if it is realistic to try to address them all but i i just i come back to the question raised by my earlier question is do we want to prioritize within these if i could speak to one of your comments miss holton about the teacher diversity index because i really think this is an important nuance as we think about teacher diversity because i think you're right i think there are lots of other factors that are impacting the diversity of our educator

[02:11:54] workforce and pipeline what i don't think we do well though is provide transparency around how that looks on an individual school basis and allow families and parents to make informed decisions about communities they're choosing to live in based on the availability of a diverse teaching workforce you often don't have that information until your child is in a school and so i think if we can provide greater transparency around those types of indicators that we know show a strong correlation to student success and student outcomes particularly for students who are marginalized by

[02:12:30] race i think that's something we should consider you know doing i'm sort of wearing my advocacy hat right now but that's my job as the equity director is to really kind of push on the things that will matter as it relates to empowering, again, those individuals who've been marginalized by the system to be better advocates and also to be able to make better informed choices.

[02:13:00] Maybe, if I may just respond, maybe the way to think of it is indicators for SOAs are primarily intended to uh encourage school divisions towards quality improvement um the school quality profiles is another way to give to do transparency and information to the public and as well as to divisions so you

know we've just got a lot of different tools and figuring out which ones are best for which indicators it may be sort of thinking about which ones do we want to use the

[02:13:35] SOA apparatus of accreditation to both hold divisions accountable and inspire quality continuous improvement. For which of these is that the best method versus other methods that are available to us? I will say that when we put up some of the demographic data about schools in the current school quality profiles we wrestled with issues that on the one hand transparency helps and on the other hand you know it may just give me used to be publishing data about um racial composition

[02:14:13] of schools was seen as a way to enable white flight so um so it's a it's just a complicated issue um and we did decide in the in the prior round of quality profile creation that that transparency was better uh more more information was better than less information but how you the nuance of how you portray that information um you know you it's just a lot of devil in the details dr man yep i know it the time is late i don't i just really want to ask i think it would be

[02:14:53] helpful for me maybe to just kind of have a cheat sheet um develop that can kind of keep me straight on i know we can't like substantially go at you know revising there's a their timeline set for when you can do what with what vehicles you're trying to move things through and i do feel like that would just be helpful for for for me to have to keep it all straight um because i do think they're the possibilities or the pathways through which to accomplish some of these things doesn't

[02:15:29] have to all live in one place so I do understand the value of accreditation and the role that these things can play when they exist within the accountability structures that exist for uh schools but it is I I am now wondering okay we have we started off talking about technical edits these are very substantial recommendations I know we're doing a lot already Dan brought forward the the SOQs and where they're so I'm just I really want to make sure from a process perspective I'm holding on to the things that are going to be acted on immediately, things that will have to sort of

[02:16:07] be embedded within a more open revision to a process that's still in process. So I don't want to lose sight of, I don't want to lose track of that in my mind. So maybe there's a way to have just a cheat sheet. Yeah, Dr. Pexton, I can talk about that for a moment if you'd like.

[02:16:29] we will certainly put together timelines of when you're required to do certain reviews and because some of those are laid out in in the regs or the code what i would say though is whereas i totally agree that with secretary holton that this was intended to be an interim kind of review of unintended consequences primarily as it relates to the soa anytime you open a regulation you're talking about a multi-year process and you ought to use that as an opportunity to address anything that you want to address and because even as you after you adopt any changes

[02:17:04] say in the next six months you could sit in you know the apa process for two years that is very helpful yeah and if i may just respond yeah and i agree i mean that that was the prior soa took you know across two governors to get done i think it was you know a five or six year process from start to finish so recognizing that dr lane is of course right that we should get important things into this my point is not that there's any legal constraint on what we can do here but rather

[02:17:41] just recognizing that we haven't let the current version uh run its course very long yet i mean it really hasn't fully been implemented yet especially with covid this year that the number of years the current system has been in effect is fully in effect it's not even there yet because the graduation

requirement changes were going to first go into effect for graduates this year or next year I think so it's not even fully rolled out yet and the staff will correct me if I'm wrong on

[02:18:17] my years but if it's fully rolled out it's barely so and so uh it really my my biggest concern is that we don't overwhelm the field when they're just figuring out how to do what we told them to do a few years ago that we're now going to tell them how to do something totally different but dr lane's right is what we're telling them now will take some years too and um maybe by the time it actually becomes reality it won't it won't seem so much so much piling on and dr man i know this

[02:18:53] isn't exactly what you asked for but we are going to do some work uh with the board to kind of lay out a more thorough work plan just so you know when things are going to be coming to you um and i'm also happy to give you a cheat sheet on uh kind of the regulatory process again not exactly what you were asking for but we have a couple things in process that can can hopefully um just give you a bigger picture no i i appreciate it i mean we're having many different conversations about many different tools and pathways and i just want to keep them straight in my head

[02:19:29] as we're moving through the process so i do have standards of learning every seven years there are some things that have been internalized but boy there's there's a lot to wrap your mind around when you look at the bureaucracy of education across the commonwealth absolutely great i know we're a little past our time but i do want to make sure that we've considered all the comments and inputs from from from all the attendees today so are there any other thoughts or

[02:19:59] questions before we we wrap things up i i just have one dr pexton i tend to stay quiet through your committee meetings as much as i can unless i ask something directly but i just want to thank the african-american superintendent's advisory council i i work really closely with them and uh and attend all the meetings and just really appreciative of of what they're putting forward and i know others have said that but just from the department i wanted to share that same kudos and uh and miles if you ever want to work at the department after college just let us know

[02:20:35] yeah i'd like to put my dibs in too i'm pretty sure in our training organization we have some sort of high level role he can fulfill for us we can help perhaps he'd like to be an architect we have options um well great so uh just to kind of wrap things up i really do want to thank everybody for today's robust discussion especially the presentation um from the space the aasac committee um really you know timely important discussion i i was very engaged with the thought

[02:21:14] the fact that it's really taking you guys are really taking a comprehensive look at all the ways possible we need to be looking at addressing the challenge that we have when it comes to equity for our minority students so really really thankful for that for that committee's work and we're looking forward to continuing to partner with you on this on this effort our next meeting will be april 20th 2021 where we will continue our discussion on equity and accountability and also receive some recommendations on potential changes to graduation requirements in the SOA. So with that, I will adjourn the meeting. Thank you all today. And if you're not wearing your green, watch out because somebody's probably going to pinch you because I've already been

[02:21:53] pinched twice. All right, guys, take care. Thanks, everybody.



Coraggio Consulting · aguyonx.com